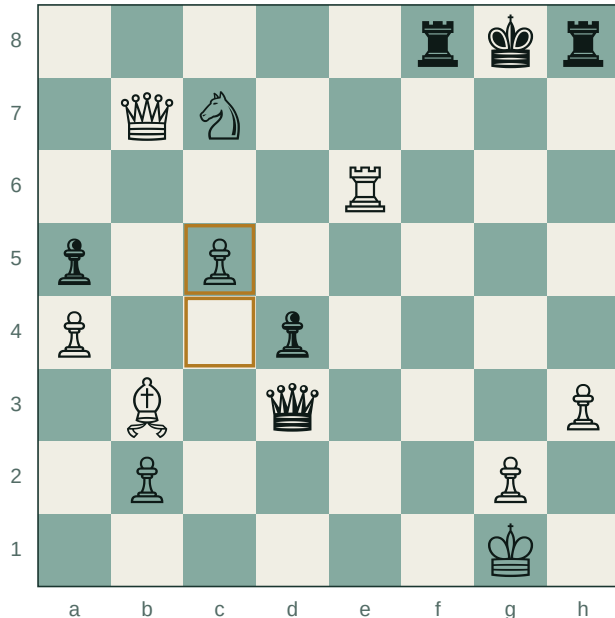


Calculated sacrifices: Black, move 44

Calculated sacrifices

Black to move



Previous move: 44.c5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

44...Rf1+ 45. Kh2 Rxb3+ 46. gxb3 Rf2+ 47. Qg2+ Rxb2+ 48. Kxb2 Qxb3

44...Rf1+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **45.Kh2**.

45...Rxb3+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. The move also takes the pawn on h3. Recorded reply: **46.gxb3**.

46...Rf2+ Check restricts White to 3 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **47.Qg2+**.

47...Rxb2+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. The move also takes the queen on g2. Recorded reply: **48.Kxb2**.

48...Qxb3 The queen captures the bishop on b3.

At the end, nominal material is White 12 / Black 11 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +3: the balance goes from -4 to -1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

An attractive attacking picture is not compensation by itself. Continue until the resulting position can be evaluated honestly.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A sacrifice exchanges material for a concrete benefit. The benefit may be mate, a stronger attack, a recovered investment, or lasting activity; it must be shown through moves.

HOW TO LOOK

State what the sacrifice changes: a defender, a line, a king square, or a critical tempo. Calculate acceptance and plausible refusal.

The defending king is on g1. Geometrically undefended: queen on b7. Check for tactical protection.